



Magnets



Magnet uses

Fridge magnets are used to hold notes on a fridge.



Metal detectors use magnets to find metal objects under the ground.



Magnets are used in spacecraft to stop things from floating around.



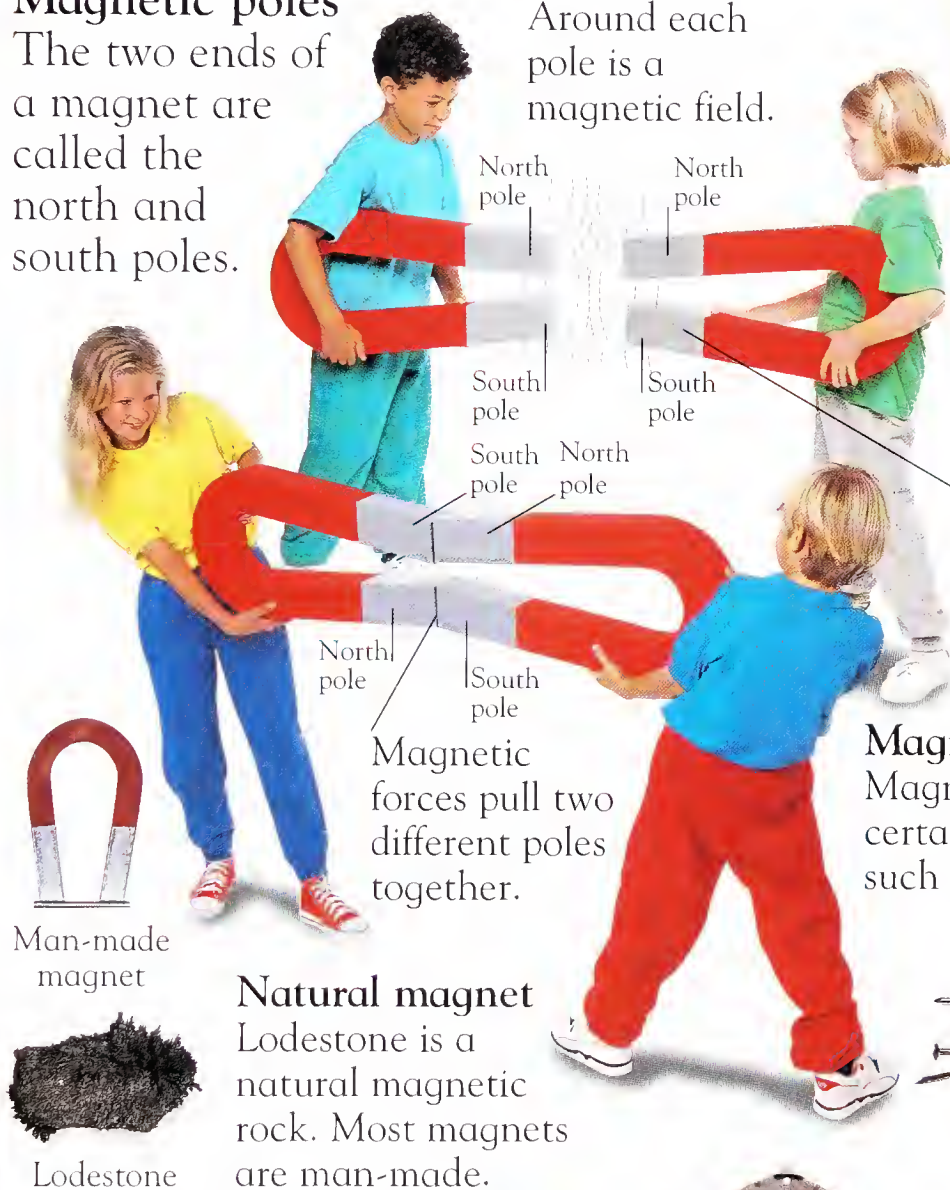
Phones and many other electrical machines use magnets.

Magnets are made from iron or steel. They look like ordinary metal, but have the power to pull things toward or push things away from them.

Magnetic poles

The two ends of a magnet are called the north and south poles.

Around each pole is a magnetic field.



The magnetic field is a powerful, invisible magnetic force.

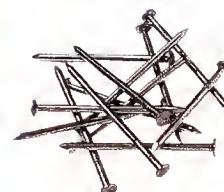
Magnetic forces push the same poles apart.



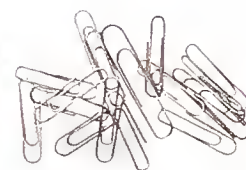
Steel spoon

Magnetic materials

Magnets only attract certain kinds of metals, such as iron and steel.



Iron nails



Steel paper clips



Man-made magnet



Lodestone

Natural magnet

Lodestone is a natural magnetic rock. Most magnets are man-made.

Magnetic Earth

The biggest magnet of all is the Earth. It has two magnetic poles that create a magnetic force around Earth.

Magnetic north pole



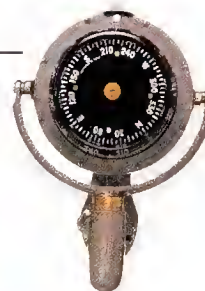
Magnetic south pole

Compass

Compass needles always point to the magnetic north pole.



Compass



A ship's compass helps sailors find their way.

Northern lights

This light show in the sky is created by the magnetic force around the Earth.

